

Conceptual Design for a BSL-3 Suitable Stage-Top Incubator



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Chapter 1

Introduction

1.1 Background and Summary

Long term Live-Cell imaging is a very useful research tool when determining long term behavior of cell cultures in various situations. Commercial solutions are unable to provide adequate containment for the use within a Bio-Safety Level 3 (BSL-3) and often require the use of a separate containment enclosure, which introduces additional costs and complexity.

This project focuses on the conceptual design of a low-cost Stage-Top Incubator that is capable of being utilized within a BSL-3 laboratory, without the requirement for additional containment.

1.2 Scope and Limitations

This project is limited to the following:

- Preliminary Research
- Temperature Control
- Compatibility with Multi-Well microtiter plates

This project is limited to compatibility with a BSL-3 Lab and does not consider higher containment requirements. The environmental control aspects of the incubator are limited to just temperature control for the preliminary conceptual design. The initial design is limited to compatibility with a multi-well microtiter plate.

Chapter 2

Research

The conceptual design began with assessing existing commercial products to identify the key environmental control specifications required for the incubator to function correctly. Additionally, this was useful in identifying why the commercial products are incompatible with a BSL-3 lab when used without a separate external biological containment mechanism.

2.1 Zeis/Pecon

The Zeis/Pecon stage top incubator utilities four modules to control the environmental conditions within the incubator stage.

The Pecon Temperature Module S regulates the temperature of the incubator. It has 4 electrical connections to the Incubator lid, base, microscope objective and humidifier device. Additionally, it directly connects to the Gas regulating units to provide temperature control of the gas flow mixture itself.

The Pecon CO₂ Module S attaches to the temperature module, and provides CO₂ concentration control to the airflow passed into the incubation chamber. It requires a pressurised CO₂ supply in order to regulate CO₂ concentration.

The Pecon O₂ Module S attaches to the CO₂ module and provides O₂ concentration control to the airflow passed into the incubation chamber. It requires a pressurised N₂ supply in order to displace the O₂ in the airflow.

The Pecon Heating Device Humidity S connects in series with the airflow tube to the incubator stage. This module works by bubbling the airflow through heated sterile water in order to raise the relative humidity (RH) to approximately 100%.

The incubator stage includes a heated glass topped lid and a heated insert which accepts mounts for the different dishes used in microscopy. The heated insert supports perfusion experiments utilising two ports which allow tubes to be run to the culture.

The main reason why the Zeis/Pecon stage top incubator system is not suitable for long term imaging without an external containment enclosure is due to the method of gas flow through the incubator. The design of the Incubator stage is such that the inflowing gas mixture flows over the culture media and then exhausts passively through the opening on the bottom and through the sides. This means that the cell culture is not completely sealed inside the incubator which can result in contamination.

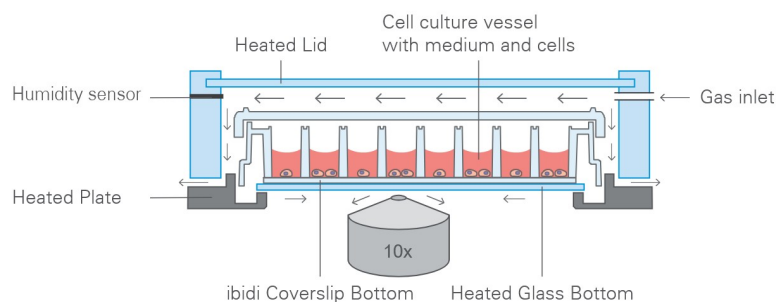


Figure 2.1: Diagram Showing the Airflow Path Within an Ibidi Multi-Well Incubator Chamber

2.2 Ibidi

The Ibidi stage top incubator functions similarly to the Zeis/Pecon module, however it makes use of only 3 modules to maintain environmental conditions.

The Heating System Silver Line module regulates the temperature of the incubation chamber stage and the microscope. The heating of the gas mixture is subjected to the gas regulator module.

The Gas Incubation System comes in two different models, the CO₂ - Silver Line and the CO₂/O₂ - Silver Line. The difference between these two systems is the former is only capable of regulating CO₂ concentration, where as the later has the ability to regulate O₂ concentration as well as CO₂ concentration. The gas incubation system is responsible for heating the gas mixture and the humidifying column to the appropriate temperature.

The Humidifying system works by mixing airflow directly from the Mixing module and from the humidifying column, which bubbles a separate airflow through heated water to obtain approximately 100% RH air. The gas mixer module then controls the mix ratio of dry gas to 100% RH gas to obtain a controlled humidity flowing into the incubation chamber.

The Ibidi incubation chamber comes in two versions, one version supports culture mediums with Petri dishes and slides, the second version supports multi-well plates. The Petri dish/Slide version of the chamber supports perfusion experiments using two ports which allow tubes to be run to the culture. Both versions support direct medium temperature monitoring which allow for more accurate temperature control by directly measuring the temperature of the culture medium.

The Ibidi system functions in a very similar fashion to the Pecon system, with the addition of being able to control the relative humidity in the chamber, rather than a forced approximate 100% relative humidity. This system still poses the same problem wherein the airflow is designed to passively exhaust from the incubation chamber, as shown in [Figure 2.1](#), and therefore does not have a seal that meets BSL-3 containment standards.

2.3 Tokai-Hit

The Tokai-Hit system functions similarly to the Pecon and Ibidi systems however it utilises a single module to regulate the environmental conditions for temperature and CO₂. Humidity is controlled by

a heated water bath inside the chamber, and O₂ control is achieved by utilising an optional module which then overrides all gas control.

The Tokai-Hit STXG/STXF temperature and CO₂ controller regulates both temperature and CO₂ concentration in the incubation chamber. The controller is capable of regulating the temperature of the top-lid heater, water bath heater, stage heater and the microscope objective heater. Additionally it is capable of regulating the airflow into the chamber depending on the model and air supply.

The incubator chamber uses a single design that is compatible with all major culture dishes including Petri dishes, slides and multi-well plates. This chamber supports perfusion experiments, drug administration and direct culture temperature measurement via access ports designed into the lid.

This system still poses the same issue as the aforementioned chambers, which prevents this chamber from forming a completely sealed environment suitable for a BSL-3 lab.

2.4 Oko-Lab

I should probably explore this option i just have not fully looked at method.

Chapter 3

Requirements Analysis

3.1 Traceability Analysis

Show how the requirements, specifications and testing procedures all link, [Table 3.1](#) is provided.

Table 3.1: Requirements Traceability Matrix

#	Requirements	Specifications	Acceptance Test
1	UR01	SP01	AT01
2	FR01	SP02,SP05	AT03

3.1.1 Traceability Analysis 1

3.1.2 Traceability Analysis 2

3.2 Requirements

The requirements for a micromouse power module are described in [Table 3.2](#).

Table 3.2: User and functional requirements of the power subsystem.

Requirement ID	Description
UR01	
FR01	

3.3 Specifications

The specifications, refined from the requirements in [Table 3.2](#), for the micromouse power module are described in [Table 3.3](#).

Table 3.3: Specifications of the sensing subsystem derived from the requirements in [Table 3.2](#).

Specification ID	Description
SP01	User

3.4 Acceptance Testing Procedures

Table 3.4: Subsystem acceptance tests

ID	Description	Testing Procedure	Pass/Fail Criteria
AT01	Powers on	• •	
		• •	

Chapter 4

Subsystem Design

4.1 Design Decisions

4.2 Final Design

The following design...



Figure 4.1: Schematic

4.3 Failure Management

Table 4.1: CAPTION

Name	Description

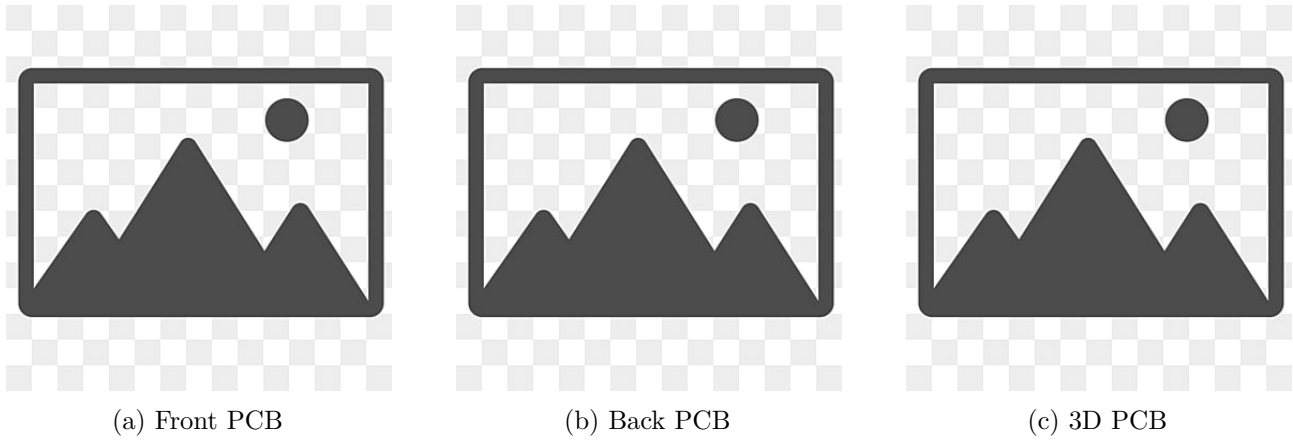


Figure 4.2: PCB

4.4 System Integration and Interfacing

To integrate the subsystem with the rest of the system

Table 4.2: Interfacing specifications

Interface	Description	Pins/Output
I001	SparkFun 9DoF IMU Breakout board to STM for data transfer (SPI)	• MISO: Breakout MISO* to STM PB14 • MOSI: Breakout MOSI* to STM PB15 • SCLK: Breakout SCLK* to STM PB13 • CS: Breakout CS* to STM PB12 (GPIO) • Power: Breakout 1V8-5V5* to STM 3V • GND: Breakout GND* to STM GND
I002	STM to FTDI for data transfer to computer (UART)	• STM PA2(RX) to FTDI RXD • STM PA3(TX) to FTDI TXD
I003	FTDI to computer for data transfer from STM	• Assuming the FTDI is connected to a Micro B USB port (which can be used to connect to a USB cable to connect to a computer), output via cable

Chapter 5

Discussion and Results

Chapter 6

Conclusion

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6.1 Recommendations

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Bibliography